

קריאת שמע על המטה (המפיל, — 2026-07-19) הריני מוחל, וסדר המהר"ם

Content-based review · reviewer read the transcript, summary, and finished write-up · 26 July 2026

1. The Shiur in One Paragraph

This was the second installment of Rabbi Ephrati's treatment of קריאת שמע על המטה — picking up from last week, where he had built up the case for saying the full סדר, and now moving into the internal parts. The arc had two centers of gravity: first, the ברכת המפיל / ביאור הלכה over the nature of (ברכת הנהנין vs. ברכת השבח) and its practical implications for saying it before a daytime nap, after חצות, and with שם ומלכות; second, a walk through the הריני מוחל declaration, the שישים גיבורים / connection, and the Maharam of Rothenburg's prison-seder as the historical anchor for what we say every night. He seemed to be after two things at once — legitimizing the widespread practice of omitting or truncating המפיל while pushing the oylam to take הריני מוחל and the surrounding תפילות much more seriously. The mashal about the guy who "can't read" and the Zohar of Rabbi Abba's traveler carried the hashkafic weight.

2. What Was Strongest

- **The Zohar maaseh of Rabbi Abba and the double נס.** Genuinely fresh, and Rabbi Ephrati let it breathe. The contrast he drew was the best move in the shiur: this Yid is greater in a certain respect even than יוסף הצדיק, because Yaakov (via Yosef) was מוחל his own brothers to preserve family peace — this Yid is מוחל every stranger, every night, without exception. That framing gives הריני מוחל a size it usually doesn't get.

- **The Biur Halacha's textual argument, cleanly stated.** He anchored the whole Chayei Adam / Mishnah Berurah dispute on the לשון of the ברכת, therefore "המפיל חבלי שינה על עיני... ויהי רצון... שתצילני." לשון יחיד ברכה מנהגו של concerns — impossible to read it as a therefore, הנהנין, therefore the correct pressure point to put on the חיי אדם and he named it clearly.
- **The Rav Asher Weiss שיטה as a third option.** Introducing R' Weiss's classification of שינה as neither proper (against the Chayei Adam's implicit הנהנין frame for daytime) nor requiring the immediacy of an אכילה was a real service — it re-opens the sugya from a direction the Mishnah Berurah didn't consider.
- **The Maharam of Rothenburg prison-seder.** The historical grounding — that the specific texts we say (המלאך הגואל, לישועתך קיויתי, יושב בסתר,) (השכיבנו, ברכת כהנים) come to us via a talmid recording what the Maharam did behind bars in Ensisheim — turns the nightly סדר from a checklist into a receipt of מסורה. That framing lands even without the halachic apparatus.
- **The Birkas Kohanim / sixty letters / שישים גיבורים tie.** Clean chiddush that resolves why ברכת כהנים would be part of a bedtime seder at all. It ties ("הנה מטתו שלשלמה... שישים גיבורים סביבותיה") שיר השירים ג' ז' to a concrete letter-count and gives the practice a reason instead of leaving it as pure custom.

3.What Was Weaker or Worth Pushing Back On

- **The Chayei Adam didn't really get his day in court.** Rabbi Ephrati echoed the Biur Halacha's difficulty ("... ויורער חיי אדם") and moved on, but the Chayei Adam's position is defensible along a different line than he presented — namely that the תפילה the מצוה was structured only around night sleep because that is what constitutes מצוה של עולם and the לשון יחיד stylistic (like מצוה ברכות השבח) rather than probative. The shiur left the

4. Halachic / Lomdish Observations

- ❑ **The Rambam is conspicuously silent.** The Rambam doesn't record ❑ קריאת
❑ a discrete practice in ❑ סלכות תפילה Some Rishonim (the Rif
❑ also omits) treat the ❑ קרא ברכות ס' ע"ב passage as ❑ שות rather than
❑ That's a ❑ שוטה worth naming, if only because it explains why some
❑ communities historically had a much lighter ❑ מהלכה than what we treat as
❑ standard.
- ❑ **The Ari"zal / Maharam alignment.** Rabbi Ephrati noted that the Maharam
❑ said only the first ❑ וברש"ה and separately mentioned that the Ari"zal was ❑ מקיים
❑ certain kabbalistic elements — but he didn't note that these actually converge: the
❑ Ari held to say only the first parashah of ❑ שמיני night (once ❑ מעריב said
❑ in ❑) which lines up precisely with the Maharam. There's a nice historical
❑ arc there — Rishonic Ashkenazi practice preserved and re-legitimized by the Ari —
❑ that he flew past.
- ❑ **המנהג המנוהג v. veners.** He mentioned that plug guys have to say the full three
❑ because that's your ❑ חסב ❑ בשכר Correct in outcome, but the
❑ underlying ❑ חלוקה Rashba/Rosh/Rabbeinu Yonah on whether the second
❑ and third ❑ פסוקים שיעל המטה ❑ חסב דאורייתא ❑ ק"ש
❑ (all) is a live sugya — the Mishnah Berurah ❑ י"א rules like the
❑ machmirim but the yesod isn't obvious.
- ❑ **The "sleep enters the ❑ שאלה question.** He raised whether ❑ שנה like ❑ ריח
❑ (Tosfos on ❑ חכמות מ"ג based on molecules entering the ❑ שולח) but didn't note
❑ that the Chida and others explicitly reject this analogy — sleep is a *withdrawal*
❑ of the ❑ שם an ingestion. That distinction actually strengthens R' Asher
❑ Weiss's position that ❑ חסב cannot be a ❑ ברכת הנהנין
- ❑ **The ❑ מיני מיכאל** ❑ The ❑ חסב cited (ר.ג.מ.נ"ו) = ❑ חסב is from ❑ ר'
❑ and appears in various forms in ❑ חסב חסידים ❑ חסב the
❑ ordering of the four ❑ חסב (which is on which side) is not uniform across
❑ sources — some have ❑ חסב the right, ❑ חסב the left. Worth flagging
❑ when leaning on the pshat.

5. Follow-up Questions Worth Asking the Rav

- Q1. On what grounds does the Chayei Adam classify **לילה** as **לילה** but treat a daytime nap as sufficiently **לילה** like to require certainty of sleep? Isn't that a self-undermining split — and if so, is the Biur Halacha's real critique that the Chayei Adam's structure is unstable, not just that his taxonomy is wrong?
- Q2. If R' Asher Weiss is right that **לילה** **לילה** **לילה** does the **לילה** minhag to omit it after **לילה** make any sense at all? A **לילה** ברכת שבת shouldn't be time-bounded — so is the **לילה** limitation a Kabbalistic overlay that presupposes the **לילה** / **לילה** framework the Rav is trying to loosen?
- Q3. On the Arizal's answer to the **לילה** **לילה** question — is the neshama's **לילה** night a real **לילה** **לילה** that would, e.g., count toward **לילה** purely a metaphysical **לילה** with no halachic status?
- Q4. The Zohar's Yid declares **לילה** — is this a **לילה** that has **לילה** / **לילה** a **לילה** / **לילה** that shifts the person's own status without necessarily **לילה** the **לילה** / **לילה** warning suggests the latter, but then how does the **לילה** / **לילה** get **לילה** from the declaration?
- Q5. The Maharam's prison-seder omitted the second and third **לילה** if he was **לילה** (minimal recitation), that's understandable — but why did the practice of only saying the first **לילה** preserved **לילה** his talmidim rather than only **לילה** is the Tashbeitz Katan explicit that this was **לילה** is our reception of it a projection back?
- Q6. If we take seriously that **לילה** included because of the sixty-letters / **לילה** connection — should a Kohen who is **לילה** daily still say it as part of **לילה** is the **לילה** were functionally protective (i.e., a **לילה** function) rather than a **לילה** ברכת הודאה / **לילה**

6. Bottom Line

This one sits comfortably in the arc of his Tefillah series — it does what Rabbi Ephrati does best, which is to take a section of the siddur most yidn skim and give it three distinct kinds of weight: halachic (the המפיל dispute), historical (the Maharam of Rothenburg), and hashkafic (הריני and the neshama in לה של מעלה). The halachic sugya on פיל doesn't fully close — the Chayei Adam gets shorter shrift than he deserves — but the מוחל material, the Zohar maaseh of Rabbi Abba, and the Maharam's prison-seder are the kind of stuff you'd repeat at a Shabbos table. Worth marking for chazarah on the הרני מוחל section specifically; worth sending to a chaver for the Zohar and the Maharam material. The פיל half is useful but not the strongest lomdish outing in the series.

Produced by a content-based review pass — the reviewer was given the full transcript, summary, and the finished write-up, and asked to react to the shiur itself (not the write-up). Complement to the Independent Editorial Review, which is a cold read of the write-up only.